Findings Chelsea FCW

Clustering results

At k = 2, Chelsea were safely clustered with front-footed teams. Then at k = 3 and k = 4, Chelsea were safely clustered with direct teams.

Like its cluster

For a strong team, Chelsea stood out for progressive passing and more directness. They were similar to its cluster for less patience, more long goal kicks, and fewer shots from open play but more from direct set piece.

Unlike its cluster

With their strength considered, Chelsea did not defend as high as it clusters, and they did not shoot much off transitions. They also carried into the final third more centrally.

Pitch profile

A fourth of their attacks went centrally. They attacked slightly more on the left side than on the right.

Formations and typical XI

Chelsea mainly used the 4-2-3-1 formation, followed by 4-4-2. They used back three formations in 22% and wingerless formations in 19% of the minutes, with 3-4-1-2 and 3-4-2-1 being their common options.

For their main formation 4-2-3-1, Sophie Ingle and Erin Cuthbert as the double pivot midfielders, Jessica Carter at one of the center back positions, Niamh Charles at left back, and Guro Reiten at left wing were more consistent positions. Other positions saw significant rotations throughout the season.

Similar teams

Bayern was the only team genuinely close to Chelsea in terms of squad. Overall, the only three teams that were close to Chelsea were Bayern, Levante Badalona, and Napoli.

Appendix

The full Chelsea team report (PDF).